Market Event Studies: filings and FOMC releases, a minute at a time

How did the market take an 8-K, or the Fed's statement, in the minutes after it came out?

In Pollis	**Compose** › **Workflows** › **Event Studies**: studies of the filings an alert on SEC filings fires, and of the FOMC's releases. Pollis captures the minute prices into `~/.pollis/event-studies`, draws the CAAR as they come in, and writes a `study.ipynb` that runs the package.
Missing in Julia	intraday event studies from minute bars: periods measured in minutes, the next open for a filing outside the session, trading that is not every minute, and the moves of rate futures at a release. The Julia event-study code we compared works on daily returns.
Package	`PollisEventStudies.jl`, registered in PollisRegistry: `run_study("path/to/study")`.
Tests	60 tests on synthetic studies whose answers are known, built minute by minute; no published table yet (see Still open).

Why a package

The packages in Pollis so far each came from a replication: a paper, its data and its printed results. This one comes from a feature: Pollis watches EDGAR and the Federal Reserve, and an event study turns an alert's filings into evidence. The analysis has to live somewhere that a notebook, a test suite and other researchers can all reach.

Two kinds of event studies

Market event studies (Fama, Fisher, Jensen and Roll 1969; MacKinlay 1997) compare each security's return around an event with a model of its normal return, and need no control group. *Panel event studies* follow an outcome of units treated at different dates against units not yet treated or never treated, period by period before and after (Sun and Abraham 2021); they serve finance, policy evaluation and health studies alike. This document is about the first. The second is to come, in this package, from the same menu item.

The data

A study is a folder: `study.toml` (the benchmark, `^GSPC` by default; the model; the estimation days, 5 by default; the periods, 30 minutes before to 120 after and the next open by default; and `group_by`), `events.csv` (a filing a row, with its form, 8-K items, EDGAR's acceptance time, the event's time, whether it came during the regular session and the next open after it) and `prices/` (a file per filing with the minute bars of the stock and of the benchmark). The event's time is the earlier of the newswire release and EDGAR's acceptance. A minute in which the stock did not trade has no bar.

The method

Normal returns

Market-adjusted: the abnormal return is the stock's log return less the benchmark's. *Market model*: alpha and beta are estimated on the regular sessions of the estimation days before the period. A thinly traded stock is measured from one trade to the next, against the benchmark's move over the same minutes, and a return over g minutes is weighed by $1/g$ (weighted least squares; ordinary least squares when the stock trades every minute). A return of zero in each minute without a trade would bias beta towards zero. This is the treatment of thin trading in Stata's eventstudy2 and in EventStudy.jl.

Cumulative abnormal returns

Each event's CAR is followed a minute at a time from the start of the period, from the filing and, for a filing outside the regular session, from the next open, where the market first trades on it. The AAR and CAAR a minute at a time come with their cross-sectional t. A filing outside the session, in a period that follows the next open, is tested at the end of the period's minutes after the next open: its CAR from the filing would end while the market is closed. Events still capturing prices count up to the last complete minute.

Tests at the end of the period, each with its two-sided p-value

- **The CAR's cross-sectional t.**
- **Boehmer, Musumeci and Poulsen (1991)**: the t of the standardized CARs, $\mathrm{SCAR}_i = \mathrm{CAR}_i/(\hat{\sigma}_i\sqrt{L_i})$, with $\hat{\sigma}_i$ the standard deviation of a minute's abnormal return on the estimation days and L_i the minutes of the period in which the stock or

the benchmark has a bar (every minute of the session, whether the stock traded or not). Robust to the volatility an event brings.

- **Adjusted for cross-correlation** (Kolari and Pynnönen 2010): events at the same time move together, and the BMP t overstates the evidence. It is multiplied by $\sqrt{(1-\bar{r})/(1+(n-1)\bar{r})}$, $\bar{r}$ the mean correlation over all pairs: that of their standardized abnormal returns over the estimation minutes they share when their periods overlap (30 at least), zero when they do not.
- **The generalized rank test** (Kolari and Pynnönen 2011): each event's SCAR, divided by the SCARs' cross-sectional standard deviation, is ranked among its standardized abnormal returns on the estimation days. Robust as well to returns far from normal; a t with $T-2$ degrees of freedom.
- **Abnormal volume**: the mean log(1 + volume) of the session's minutes after the event (or the next open) less that of its minutes before, with its cross-sectional t.

The p-values come from Student's t (Distributions.jl), with $n-1$ degrees of freedom for the cross-sectional tests.

Groups

With `group_by` (`"form"`, `"item"`, `"session"`, `"ticker"`, or a function of the event) every result above is given for each group too; a filing with several 8-K items is in the group of each. Pollis sets it from the study's Group By field. Grouping follows EventStudy.jl.

FOMC releases

For the statement, projections and minutes, the move of each instrument over each period (10 minutes before to 20 after by default): federal funds and SOFR futures in basis points of the implied rate, FF1 scaled by $D/(D-d)$, D the days of the month and d the release's day, and FF2 in its place in the month's last week (Kuttner 2001); the 5- and 10-year yields in basis points; prices in per cent. The mean move with its cross-sectional t, and the mean path a minute at a time.

A worked example

The study

Pollis writes `study.toml` when the study is made on the Event Studies page, with a comment over each setting. A study of the filings of an alert on 8-Ks, with the market model, grouped by session:

```
title = "Earnings 8-Ks"
alert = "earnings-8k"
benchmark = "^GSPC"
model = "marketModel"
event_time = "firstPublic"
estimation_days = 5
group_by = "session"

[[periods]]
name = "Default"
before = 30
after = 120
next_open = true

[[periods]]
name = "Short Run"
before = 5
after = 15
next_open = false
```

The report

`run_study(folder)` reads the folder, analyses each period, prints the report and writes `results/`. Below, the report of the package's synthetic study of three filings (the first of the tests), of its Default period: one filing during the session that jumps 2%, one after Friday's close that falls 3% at Monday's open, and one during the session that jumps 1%. The AAR and CAAR tables are printed at minutes −30, −15, −5, 0, 1, 5, 15, 30, 60 and 120; the files hold every minute.

```
Synthetic: benchmark ^GSPC, market model on the 5 trading days before; 3 events with a ticker
and an acceptance time

Default: 30 minutes before the filing to 120 after; 3 events with prices

Minutes from the filing
  minute  events      AAR %        t     CAAR %        t
     -30       3                          0.000
      -5       3     -0.067   -1.684     -0.023   -1.549
       0       3      0.011    0.644     -0.045   -0.254
       1       3      1.116    1.785      1.071    1.961
      15       3     -0.010   -0.386      0.937    1.986
     120       3      0.086    1.689      1.618    1.997
```

```
Minutes from the next open, 1 events
  minute  events      AAR %        t     CAAR %        t
       0       1                          0.000
       1       1     -2.974              -2.974
     120       1     -0.062              -1.919

At +120 minutes: CAR 0.978% (t = 0.675, p = 0.569, 3 events)
Boehmer, Musumeci and Poulsen: mean standardized CAR 0.737 (t = 0.600, p = 0.609, 3 events)
  adjusted for cross-correlation (Kolari and Pynnonen 2010, mean correlation -0.008): t = 0.608,
  p = 0.605
Generalized rank test (Kolari and Pynnonen 2011): t = 0.713, p = 0.476
Abnormal volume: 0.811 (t = 91.512, p = 0.000, 3 events)

By session, at +120 minutes
session                  events      CAR %        t    BMP t     KP t  GRANK t     volume        t
During the session            2      2.426   31.783   34.831   34.831    2.458      0.808   55.958
Outside the session           1     -1.919                                         0.817
```

The filing after the close is tested on the 120 minutes after Monday's open, where the market first traded on it: −1.919%, the last row of the table from the next open, not the zero of the closed market after the filing. Two filings up and one down give a mean CAR of 0.978% that no test finds evidence in; the two during the session, a group of their own, give 2.426% (t = 31.8). Friday's filing, followed to Monday afternoon, overlaps Monday's filing: their standardized abnormal returns are correlated over the estimation minutes they share ($\bar{r}$ = −0.008), and the BMP t moves from 0.600 to 0.608.

The files

`write_results` writes, for each period (its name in lower case, with hyphens):

File	What it holds
`default-events.csv`	an event a row: its CAR, standardized CAR, abnormal volume and beta
`default-from-the-filing.csv`	a minute a row: the events known then, the AAR and CAAR with their t
`default-from-the-next-open.csv`	the same from the next open, for the filings outside the session
`default-groups.csv`	a group a row: its events and its tests at the end of the period, with their p-values
`default-groups-from-the-filing.csv`	each group's AAR and CAAR a minute at a time, each row with its group
`default-groups-from-the-next-open.csv`	the same from the next open

A study of FOMC releases writes `tight-moves.csv` (a release a row, an instrument a column), `tight-summary.csv` (an instrument a row: its unit, releases, mean move, standard deviation and t) and `tight-paths.csv` (the mean move a minute at a time, by instrument).

In Julia, `results = analyse(read_study(folder))` gives the same, a named tuple a period:

- `results[1].tests`: the tests at the end of the period, with their p-values;
- `results[1].events`: the events' table;
- `results[1].from_filing` and `results[1].from_open`: the AAR and CAAR a minute at a time;
- `results[1].curves`: each event's CAR a minute at a time;
- `results[1].groups`: the same for each group, with its `name`.

`report(results)` prints them and `write_results(results, folder)` writes them.

The notebook

Each study folder has a `study.ipynb` that Pollis writes when the study is made, a Julia notebook in four parts:

1. **What the folder holds**: `study.toml`, `events.csv`, `prices/` and `news/` (the articles Google News lists from a day before each filing to a day after), and what the package computes from them.
2. **Install and run.** The cell adds PollisRegistry when it is not among the registries, adds PollisEventStudies when it is not installed and updates it when it is older than the study needs, then runs `run_study` on the notebook's own folder (or the study's path, when the notebook was moved), which prints the report and writes `results/`.
3. **Each event**: `results[1].events`, the table of the first period's events.
4. **Notes**: the two models of normal returns, the estimation days the BMP test needs, Yahoo Finance's 30 days of minute prices, and the benchmark's trading only during the session.

Events still capturing prices count up to the last complete minute, so running the notebook again as they come in brings the results up to date. A study of FOMC releases has its own notebook, with the instruments, the contract months, Kuttner's scaling and `results[1].moves`.

What the tests show

Three synthetic filings over seven trading days, with known betas, jumps and volume; one filed after Friday's close.

Test	Built in	Measured
Betas	1.2, 0.8, 1.0	1.195, 0.828, 0.988
Jump at the filing	+2%, +1%	+1.79%, +1.42% the minute after
Jump at Monday's open	−3%	−2.97%
Thin trading, a trade every 4th minute	beta 1.0	0.93 (zeros in between: 0.33)
Abnormal volume, 5× for 60 of 120 minutes	log 5/2 = 0.805	0.811 (t = 91.5)
Cross-correlation, independent noise	near 0	−0.008; BMP t 0.600, KP t 0.608
Cross-correlation, two of three events alike	$\bar{r}$ = 1/3, factor $\sqrt{0.4}$	0.33333, 0.63246
Generalized rank, CARs far out	large t	t = 3.83, p = 0.0002
Generalized rank, CARs among the rest	no evidence	t = 0.61, p = 0.55
FOMC: FF1 −10 cents on the 10th, scaled 30/20	15 bp	15 bp, to 9 decimals
FOMC: 5-minute bars, FF1 −5 cents	5 bp from minute 5	mean path 7.5 bp at minute 1, 10 at 5

The tests also check the groups, the files written, the events still capturing and a study without events.

Panel event studies

Units of a panel first treated at different times (firms adopting a rule, states passing a law, hospitals joining a stepped-wedge trial) against units not yet or never treated. `panel_event_study` takes any Tables.jl table, a row a unit and a time, and gives the effect at each event time (the time since the unit was first treated) from `-leads` to `lags`, against the `reference` event time (−1 by default); event times beyond the ends count at the ends, and units treated from the first time are left out.

```
results = panel_event_study(table; unit = "state", time = "year", outcome = "y",
    cohort = "first_treated", leads = 5, lags = 5)
report(results)
```

Three estimators

- **Two-way fixed effects (TWFE).** The outcome on unit and time effects and an indicator of each event time. With effects that differ from cohort to cohort, its effects mix in those of other event times, before treatment too, with weights that can be negative.
- **Sun and Abraham (2021).** Each cohort's effect at each event time against the control units (`control = "never"`, the units never treated, or `"last"`, the units treated last, before their treatment), averaged over the cohorts with their shares of the event time's observations.
- **Callaway and Sant'Anna (2021),** `callaway_santanna`. Each cohort's effect at each time, ATT(g, t), a difference in differences against the units never treated, not yet treated or treated last; from a varying or a universal base period; doubly robust (Sant'Anna and Zhao 2020), by inverse probability weighting or by outcome regression, with covariates; then aggregated by event time, by cohort, by calendar time and overall, the standard errors counting the estimation of the cohorts' shares. It is a port of R's did and DRDID.

Each result of `panel_event_study` has the effects by event time, each cohort's, the pre-trends test (that the effects before the reference event time are all zero) and the sample. `weights` weighs the observations and `covariates` are added to both regressions. A study folder with `source = "panel"` in `study.toml` names the table, the same keywords and the estimators (`estimators`: `panel_event_study`, `callaway_santanna` or both), the second's own keywords in a `[callaway_santanna]` table, so that a study made on Pollis's Event Studies page can run either.

Standard errors: three choices

Standard errors are clustered by `cluster`, the unit by default. Three keywords set how, each with the package's choice as the default and R's as the other:

- `small_sample` (`true`): Stata's small-sample factor $\frac{G}{G-1}\frac{N-1}{N-K}$, G the clusters, N the observations and K the parameters, as fixest; `false` leaves it out, as did.
- `fixed_shares` (`false`): Sun and Abraham's variance adds that of the cohorts' shares, which are estimated too, clustered as the cohorts' effects, as did; `true` holds the shares fixed, as fixest.
- `distribution` (`"t"`): p-values and the 95% bands from Student's t with $G - 1$ degrees of freedom, and the pre-trends test as $F(q, G - 1)$; `"normal"` takes the normal and $\chi^2(q)$, as did.

t or the normal

The normal is asymptotic. The standard errors come from an influence function, which justifies the normal as the number of clusters grows; with 50 states it is a fair approximation. The t with $G - 1$ degrees of freedom is a small-sample correction, Stata's convention, which fixest follows. With few clusters the clustered standard errors are themselves noisy, and the t's thicker tails allow for that. With 10 to 20 clusters the difference is real: with 15, the 5% critical value is 2.14 under $t(14)$ and 1.96 under the normal. With 50 it is 2.01, and with hundreds of clusters the two agree.

Against R

R is the benchmark for these estimators. The tests run the package and R on the same synthetic panels: 60 units over 12 years in three cohorts and a never-treated group, with effects that differ from cohort to cohort.

R	Keywords	Equal to 6 decimals
fixest, `sunab` and `i()`	`fixed_shares = true`	49 cohort and TWFE effects and standard errors, with weights, a covariate and clusters coarser than the units; 32 effects by event time and their standard errors; 14 with the last-treated control
did (Callaway and Sant'Anna 2021), `att_gt` (never treated, universal base period) and `aggte(type = "dynamic")`, `bstrap = FALSE, cband = FALSE`	`small_sample = false, distribution = "normal"`	33 cohort effects; 16 effects by event time with their standard errors, p-values and 95% bands
did, `att_gt` and `aggte` (dynamic, group, calendar, simple), `bstrap = FALSE, cband = FALSE`	`callaway_santanna`, `distribution = "normal"`	In six configurations (each control group, base period and method, with weights, a covariate, coarser clusters, anticipation, and with no units never treated): 164 cells, 85 effects by event time, 15 by cohort, 45 by calendar time and 24 overall, with their standard errors, to 5e-13; the pre-trends test; `min_e`, `max_e` and `balance_e`

did is Sun and Abraham's estimator only with the never-treated control, a universal base period and no covariates. Its default bands are simultaneous, from a multiplier bootstrap; `bstrap = FALSE, cband = FALSE` gives the pointwise bands compared here. Stata's eventstudyinteract takes the shares' variance observation by observation, which gives the same variance at each event time when each unit is a cluster and no event time is beyond the ends, but no covariance between event times. Not yet checked against R: the binned ends, the pre-trends test and the weighted last-treated control. The bootstraps are in the next section, and datasets with gaps in the one after.

Bootstrap

The bootstrap serves the panel estimators three ways: standard errors that need no formula, bands that cover all the event times at once, and tests that hold with few clusters. Each takes `draws` and `seed`, to repeat the draws.

Bootstrap	Keywords	What it gives
did's multiplier bootstrap	`callaway_santanna`: `bootstrap = true`; `panel_event_study`: `uniform = true, multiplier = true`	Standard errors and simultaneous bands for Callaway and Sant'Anna; did's critical values for TWFE and Sun and Abraham
Sup-t	`panel_event_study`: `uniform = true`	Simultaneous bands for TWFE and Sun and Abraham
Wild cluster bootstrap	`panel_event_study`: `wild = true`, after `using WildBootTests`	p-values and 95% intervals for each effect, and the pre-trends test, with few clusters

Simultaneous bands

A 95% band at each event time covers that event time's effect 95% of the time; drawn together on an event-study plot, the bands cover all the effects at once far less often. Simultaneous bands cover them all together 95% of the time: each effect $\pm$ a critical value c times its standard error, c the 95% quantile of the largest $|t|$ over the event times. The package draws that largest $|t|$ two ways.

- **Sup-t** (Montiel Olea and Plagborg-Møller 2019), the default: from the effects' estimated correlations, normal or Student's t as `distribution` (10,000 draws by default).
- **did's multiplier bootstrap**: each cluster's influence on the effects weighed by +1 or -1 in each draw, each effect's draws scaled by their interquartile range over the normal's, and the pointwise value when the simultaneous one is smaller, as did's `aggte`. For `callaway_santanna` it also gives the standard errors.

On the test panel, Sun and Abraham's 16 event times under the normal give 2.777 by sup-t, between the pointwise 1.960 and Bonferroni's 2.955. By did's multiplier bootstrap they give 2.706, and did itself 2.708 (200,000 draws each). The two ways differ by the weights alone: over 60 clusters, weights of +1 or -1 give the largest $|t|$ thinner tails than normal draws do, and normal weights on the same influences give 2.775. For `callaway_santanna`, with 100,000 draws, the critical values and standard errors are did's within the noise of the draws (2.743 against 2.747 for the event times, 0.1725 against 0.1729 for a cell's standard error).

The wild cluster bootstrap

Clustered standard errors assume many clusters. With 10 to 30, tests on them reject too often, even with t's critical values

(Cameron, Gelbach and Miller 2008). The wild cluster bootstrap does better: it refits the regression with the null imposed, and in each draw multiplies each cluster's residuals by a single random weight, keeping their correlation within the cluster; the p-value is the share of the draws whose $|t|$ is at least the data's. The interval holds the values the test does not reject at 5%. With `wild = true`, each effect of TWFE and of Sun and Abraham has its p-value and interval, and the pre-trends test its p-value, a Wald test with the null imposed. The weights are +1 or −1 (`wild_weights = "rademacher"`), every one of the 2^G patterns of signs when there are no more than `draws`, or Webb's (2023) six values (`"webb"`), better with fewer than about 12 clusters, whose 2^G patterns are then too few. Sun and Abraham's effects hold the cohorts' shares fixed. The bootstrap runs in David Roodman's WildBootTests.jl (Roodman, MacKinnon, Nielsen and Webb 2019), the algorithms of Stata's boottest, which the package loads only when asked for.

Against R's fwildclusterboot (`boottest` on fixest's `i()` and `sunab`), on the test panel with weights, a covariate and 12 clusters, so that all 4,096 patterns are drawn: the p-values are R's to 6 decimals (0.032715 for TWFE at event time −2, 134 of the 4,096 draws; 0.966309 for Sun and Abraham). The p-value is a step function of the value tested, and the interval's bound is where it falls below 5%. Neither program finds that point exactly: TWFE's upper bound at event time 3 is 1.158875, R stops its root search after 10 iterations at 1.158985, and WildBootTests stops within a step of 5% at 1.159517. Both are on the step past the bound, so the intervals agree to its width, here 0.0005.

Unbalanced datasets

Real panels have gaps: a firm enters the sample late, leaves it, or misses a year of data. A panel is unbalanced when some units are not observed at every time. Gaps do not bias the estimates when they are unrelated to the outcome; when units leave because of how they fare, no estimator here corrects that.

TWFE and Sun and Abraham

`panel_event_study` needs no option. Its regression takes every observation there is, and the unit and time effects absorb who is present when. On a panel where half the 60 units miss a year or two, it agrees with fixest to 6 decimals, effects and standard errors, with weights, a covariate and clusters coarser than the units.

Callaway and Sant'Anna

Each ATT(g, t) is a change from the base period to t, which a unit missing at either time does not have. By default, as in did, `callaway_santanna` leaves out every unit not observed at every time, and the report says how many. With `unbalanced = true`, as did's `allow_unbalanced_panel`, it keeps them:

- each cell compares the observations at t and at the base period as two cross sections, with the estimators of Sant'Anna and Zhao 2020 for repeated cross sections (DRDID's `drdid_rc`, `std_ipw_did_rc` and `reg_did_rc`), each observation with its own covariates and weight;
- a unit's influence is the sum of its observations', so the standard errors, clustered or bootstrapped, still treat a unit's observations as one;
- the cohorts' sizes weigh each unit by the mean of its weights.

When every unit is observed at every time, the option changes nothing. Keeping the units with gaps keeps their information, but each cell no longer differences a unit's outcome against itself, which costs precision when units differ a lot. On the same panel the effect at event time 0, whose true value is $(0.4 + 2.0 - 1.0)/3 \approx 0.467$:

Panel	Effect at 0	Standard error
The 30 units with gaps left out (default)	0.380	0.259
All 60 units, `unbalanced = true`	0.494	0.196
The full panel, without gaps	0.468	0.187

Against did 2.5.1 with `allow_unbalanced_panel = TRUE`, in five configurations (each method, the not-yet-treated control, a universal base period, weights, a covariate and coarser clusters), the cells, the effects by event time, by cohort and overall, their standard errors and the pre-trends test are equal to 6 decimals.

Still open

- **A published table.** Every test is synthetic. The package needs an intraday study whose events and results are published and whose prices can be had today, to be tested against as the other packages are.
- **Estimation days.** Pollis captures them for the market model only, so market-adjusted studies have no standardized tests (BMP, its adjustment and the generalized rank test) unless the prices before the period happen to be there.
- **Panel Event Studies in Pollis.** The package has them; the Event Studies page and a notebook for them are still to come.

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Package written and tested with Claude Code (Anthropic) in Pollis.
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